THE PROBLEM & STATISTICS

Japanese SMEs have competitive products and technology, but entering India and building a sustainable presence is difficult for them due to several reasons:

Market research: local demand, customers, state-wise differences

- Wrong targeting and wasted entry budget

Partner matchmaking: no network to find partners

- Entry stalls: nothing else can begin

Partner verification: can't check reliability or track record

- High risk of an unreliable partner

Due diligence and culture gap: costly, slow, no local office

- Lost time, money, IP and reputation

Regulatory compliance: registration, GST, customs, state rules

- Delayed and expensive launch

GTM execution: localising product, packaging and pricing

- Weak adoption by Indian customers

80%+

of Japanese firms in India plan to expand

~20%

of 1,400+ Japanese firms in India are SMEs

55.2%

plan to increase local sourcing

Sources: JETRO Surveys on Business Conditions of Japanese-Affiliated Companies Overseas, Asia & Oceania (2023, 2024, 2025); JETRO India

THE ISSUES WE ADDRESS AND OUR APPROACH TOWARDS THEM

India entry fails on execution, not information, and SMEs face it alone.

Partner & payment risk

Unverified distributors can **take advance payments or stock and vanish**, delay payments or default. With no way to check them, one bad partner can drain an SME's **entire India budget**.

Operational friction

No local office or staff to **audit warehouses, check stock, chase payments** or meet partners in person, **especially in tier-2 and tier-3 cities**.

Regulatory & tax risk

GST, customs, licences and state rules are complex, and **mistakes bring penalties and director liability**. JETRO and the Embassy of India make introductions, but **no one supports execution on the ground**.

Our Solution: An AI-powered platform backed by a **vetted network of Indian experts**. The AI does the groundwork fast; licensed lawyers, CAs and field auditors **verify, sign off and act on the ground**, so SMEs can enter India safely without building their own India team.

Sources: JETRO Surveys (2023–2025); Embassy of India, Tokyo

OUR SOLUTION

Musubi Gateway: AI speed, backed by experts on the ground

Musubi Gateway is an **AI-powered platform backed by a vetted network of Indian experts**. The AI does the groundwork fast: finding partners, translating, preparing documents. **Licensed lawyers, CAs and field auditors then verify, sign off and act on the ground.** The business owner makes every final decision, so SMEs can enter India safely without building their own India team.

Purple outline = AI task (speed, automation) · **Orange outline = AI + Expert task** (field audit, filing, legal sign-off)

1 Market Scan

Suggests the best Indian states for the product, and checks whether price and packaging fit.

2 Partner Finder + Shinrai Score

Scores partners 0–100 from digital data, plus **field audits, trade references and trial orders**. Offline visits let us verify **tier-2 and tier-3 distributors** with little online record.

3 Language Bridge

Translates business meaning, not just words, between Japanese and Indian business English.

4 Negotiation Coach

Suggests phrases, fair margins and payment terms, and flags risky clauses.

5 Compliance & Tax Assistant

AI prepares GST, customs and licence paperwork from official sources; **a licensed CA reviews and files it**.

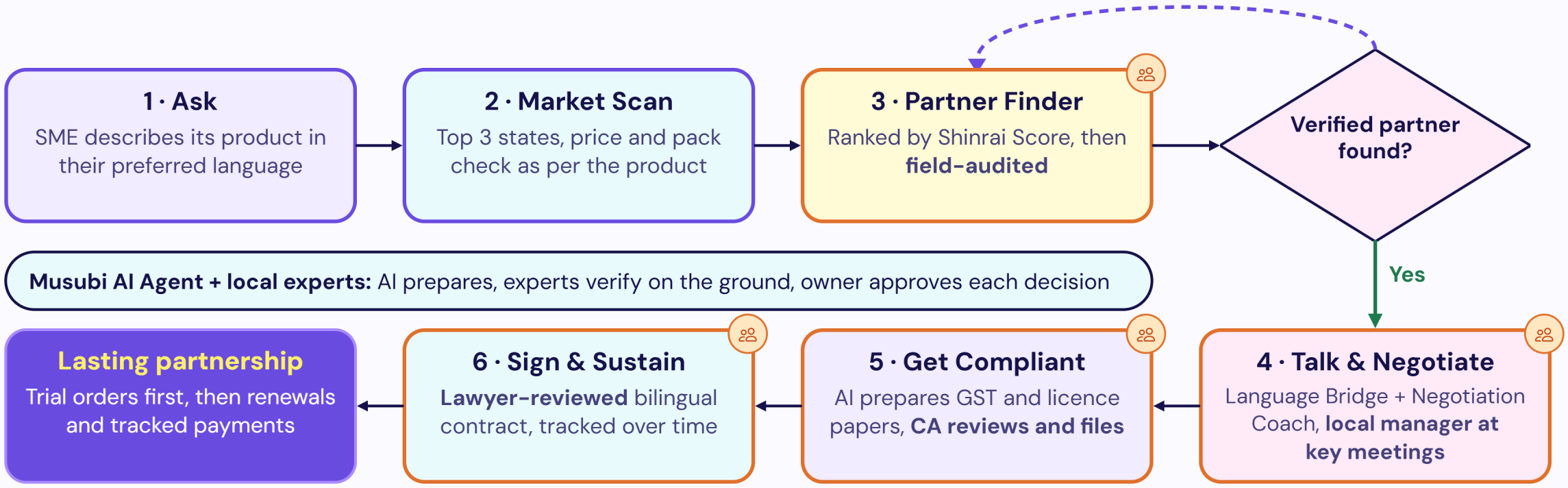
6 Contract Manager

AI drafts bilingual contracts; **a lawyer reviews and signs off**. Then renewals, payments and obligations are tracked.

HOW IT WORKS?

From First Question to Signed Partnership

Purple = AI task · Orange = AI + Expert task



Musubi AI Agent + local experts: AI prepares, experts verify on the ground, owner approves each decision

Pilot plan (next 6 months): Month 1–2 · validate the Shinrai Score against 50 historical Indian distributor datasets → Month 3–4 · onboard 5 Indian legal and tax advisors to test the expert review dashboard → Month 5–6 · closed alpha pilot with 2 Japanese SMEs entering India.

TECHNICAL SYSTEM

One AI Agent, Six Tools, One Expert Network

1 · Interface: React + Tailwind
Multilingual chat and dashboards, PDF reports, **portal for auditors, CAs and lawyers**

↓

2 · Agent: LLM + LangGraph
Picks the right tool, **routes tasks to experts**, pauses for owner approval

↓

3 · Tools: Python FastAPI
Six services, one per feature

↓

4 · Data: PostgreSQL + Chroma
GSTN API (via GSPs), MCA21, e-way bill data (with partner consent), regulator sites + field audit reports

Tool	How we build it
Market Scan	Python scoring model on public state data: population, income, urbanisation, e-commerce
Shinrai Score	Weighted 0–100 score: GSTN, MCA21, e-way bill and credit data + field audits, trade references, trial-order payments; confidence level shown
Language Bridge	LLM with business-context prompts and a trade glossary (Keigo ⇄ Indian business English)
Negotiation Coach	LLM grounded in sector data on margins, payment terms and contract clauses
Compliance & Tax	RAG over official CBIC, DGFT, BIS, FSSAI documents; AI prepares, licensed CA reviews and files
Contract Manager	AI drafts bilingual contracts from templates; lawyer reviews and signs off; scheduler tracks renewals and payments

BUILD PLAN & ISSUES SOLVED

Hackathon Build (24–25 Oct) and What It Resolves

1. State data, regulator docs, 30–50 sample partners, **sample field-audit reports**, Figma screens
2. Backend, database, Shinrai Score engine (**digital + field signals**)
3. Agent with tool calling, Partner Finder, Market Scan
4. Language Bridge, Negotiation Coach, compliance RAG
5. Contract tracker, **expert portal for auditors, CAs and lawyers**, multilingual UI polish
6. Full demo run, testing, pitch practice

Built responsibly: AI prepares, licensed experts verify and sign off · every score shows its source and confidence level · **sensitive corporate documents are encrypted and shared only with consent, in line with India's DPDP Act 2023 and Japan's APPI** · the owner approves every key decision · demo uses clearly labelled sample data.

Issues solved: every barrier from slides 1–2

- **Choosing the market** → Market Scan
- **Language & negotiation gaps** → Language Bridge + Negotiation Coach
- **Regulatory & tax risk** → AI-prepared, CA and lawyer signed
- **Partner & payment risk** → Shinrai Score, field audits, trial orders
- **Operational friction** → field auditors and local managers
- **Scattered, costly help** → one platform, one expert network

Team Shinrai-No-Musubi: Sukhman Bhullar · Gurleen Kaur · Amoljit Kaur · First-years, Thapar Institute (TIET)